

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 19, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 16:13-24

13 Watch, stand fast in the faith, be brave, be strong.

14 Let all that you do be done with love.

15 I urge you, brethren—you know the household of Stephanas, that it is the firstfruits of Achaia, and that they have devoted themselves to the ministry of the saints—

16 that you also submit to such, and to everyone who works and labors with us.

17 I am glad about the coming of Stephanas, Fortunatus, and Achaicus, for what was lacking on your part they supplied.

18 For they refreshed my spirit and yours. Therefore acknowledge such men.

19 The churches of Asia greet you. Aquila and Priscilla greet you heartily in the Lord, with the church that is in their house.

20 All the brethren greet you. Greet one another with a holy kiss.

21 The salutation with my own hand—Paul's.

22 If anyone does not love the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be accursed. O Lord, come!

23 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.

24 My love be with you all in Christ Jesus. Amen.

II. Key Summary

- Paul closes with four commands — watch, stand fast in the faith, be brave, be strong — calling the Corinthians to stay alert and firm in their faith (v. 13)
- Paul immediately follows with "let all that you do be done with love," making love the foundation and motivation behind every action (v. 14)
- Paul writes the closing in his own hand, pronouncing a solemn warning against those

who do not love the Lord, then ending with a blessing of grace and love (vv. 22–24)

III. Passage Analysis

Standing Firm Like a Soldier — Without Losing Gentleness

"Watch ye — watch, and be continually on your guard, lest you be surprised by your enemies... Stand fast in the faith — keep in your ranks; be determined to keep your ranks unbroken... Quit yourselves like men — when you are attacked, do not flinch; maintain your ground; resist; press forward; strike home." [1]

Paul strings four military commands together, calling the Corinthians to hold their ground against false teaching, temptation, and anything that would pull them away from what's true. "Standing firm" here isn't about being aggressive or combative — it's about not being easily shaken on the things that actually matter.

Strength Means Nothing Without Love

"All the watching, all the standing fast, all the bravery, and all the strength the Corinthian Christians might show meant nothing without love. They were called to do all those things in a meek, humble spirit of love." [2]

Right after four tough commands, Paul adds one more: do everything in love. The order matters. Strength and courage are real Christian virtues, but love is what gives them meaning. You can hold your ground and stay firm, yet still do it all out of genuine care for the people around you.

IV. Reflection Question

Think of something you did for someone else — but honestly, you weren't fully into it. Did it feel like love, or more like obligation?

Paul says "let all that you do be done with love" — love isn't just a feeling, it's the motivation that makes what you do real and worth something.

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Adam Clarke's Commentary,

https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/16-13.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary on 1 Corinthians 16,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-16/>